

Browsercalypse!

March has been a month of browser releases, and not just your teeny point version – no mere security updates these!

Google Chrome reached version 10, Microsoft finally released Internet Explorer 9, and if all went well, Firefox 4.0 would finally make up for all the loss in the days to come. Opera released beta 11.10, but more importantly, a slew of mobile browsers.

Google Chrome 10

Google released the most significant update to their engine since Google Chrome 5. Their V8 engine now reaches the third version code-named “Crankshaft”. The new engine promises a big boost for JavaScript and boasts of 66 per cent improvement for the browser that was no slouch to begin with.

Another significant update to come with Google Chrome 10 with a settings interface that opens as a tab in the browser. The various settings pages actually have unique URLs so you can simply paste them in an email conversation. You can even search for the particular setting you want using a search box.

Google Chrome 10 also adds support for synchronising saved passwords (encrypted of course), GPU accelerated video, malware reporting, automatic disabling of outdated plugins, and sandboxing for Adobe Flash on Windows.

With background WebApps, your webmail client can keep check your email and notify you even when the tab is minimised or closed.

IE9 is here

Microsoft's latest browser is a bold step forward in standards compliance and performance. It embraces newer open web technologies such as HTML5 and CSS3 with support for video and audio tags, canvas, web fonts, inline SVG support and more.

Microsoft Internet Explorer 9 not only rivals current generation browsers in JavaScript performance, but goes a step further to improve the performance of rich media in the browser with hardware acceleration. In fact, now the

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Opera's bouquet

Great things lie ahead for Opera too as it released Opera 11.10 beta, a minor version bump but still a significant update. Opera 11.10 brings a better speed dial that allows unlimited sites, and a new way for web masters to specify an icon for the speeddial. Opera 11.0 continues its trend in supporting the latest web standards with CSS3 improvements, WOFF support and even support for

browser is effective on these phones too. You can enjoy multiple tabs with an enhanced browsing experience.

Opera makes its debut on tablets with Opera Mobile builds for MeeGo, Android, and Windows 7 on touch-enabled devices. It features a new tablet-optimised interface that brings the best of Opera features (Turbo and Link) to tablets.

Opera now supports smoother scrolling, panning and zooming, as well as true pinch-to-zoom gestures for zooming in across all platforms. Versions are also enhanced with new sharing features that allow you to post to Twitter, Facebook or MyOpera.



Dean Hachamovitch, corporate vice president, Internet Explorer, presents the keynote speech at the Internet Explorer 9 RTW event on March 14, 2011, at SXSW in Austin, Texas

browser even checks performance of third-party addons and displays the kind of time each one takes to activate, allowing you to disable them easily.

Internet Explorer 9 features a new highly compact interface that even combines the address-bar and task-bar making it the most compact browser of all currently.

You can also pin your favourite web site to your taskbar, if you are using Windows 7. The site then acts like a web application, with its own

Google's WebP image format. If you don't have the latest Flash plugin, Opera 11.10 can download it automatically.

Opera also launched Opera Mini 6 for J2ME (most Java-phones), Android, BlackBerry, Symbian / S60, and Opera Mobile 11 for Android, and Symbian. Labs releases of Opera Mobile 11 are also available for Windows 7 desktops / tablets (not Windows 7 Phone), MeeGo, and Maemo. Opera hasn't ignored budget Java-based phones, and its mobile

Pwn2Own

Weeks ahead of the Pwn2Own onslaught, browser vendors began toughening up their browsers – with numerous updates patching bugs and securing vulnerabilities. A total of \$125,000 are at stake this year at Pwn2Own, out of which \$20,000 comes as bounty from Google themselves, for those who can “best” the Google Chrome browser.

Pwned is leetspeak used by gamers instead of 'owned' especially when they win or conquer their opponents. Pwn2Own is an annual hacking competition that is held as a part of the CanSecWest security conference. Researchers and security experts are asked to hack or 'pwn' the browser, i.e., make it run arbitrary code, and, gain control of the machine it is running on. 2011's Pwn2Own was different in that hackers also had to escape any sandboxes lying in wait – areas that limit a code's access to resources. All winners